Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)
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October 22, 2026

Hiring Team
FTI Consulting — Economic Consulting, Hong Kong
Re: Graduate Consultant, Economic & Financial Consulting (JR261504)

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Graduate Consultant role in FTI Consulting's Economic & Financial Consulting practice in Hong Kong (JR261504). I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at HKUST (expected June 2027; I can finish earlier if preferred), a Hong Kong permanent resident with the right to work in Hong Kong, a native Mandarin speaker, and professionally fluent in English. The practice's focus—expert evidence on damages quantification, business and instrument valuation, and loss of profits in commercial and investment-treaty disputes—matches how I work: build a model that ties evidence to theory, quantify counterfactual outcomes, and present the result clearly in a compact team. What I offer is strong statistical and modeling training, a habit of learning new industries and methods quickly, and clear written and verbal communication: I structure complex ideas for non-specialists, produce careful work to deadlines, and collaborate in Mandarin and English.

The role's day-to-day is close to what I do in research: identify relevant material and deliver supporting research; design and build models and perform financial and statistical analysis; analyse large volumes of data; and assist with reports, written analyses, presentations, and quantitative exhibits—including investigating and critiquing the analyses of other experts. In my job market paper on Taobao apparel return policy, I clean large transaction data, estimate a structural model of purchase, return, and return-shipping insurance, rank policies by welfare, and decompose losses into an ex-ante purchase margin and an ex-post keep-or-return margin—the same discipline of quantifying economic outcomes under counterfactual scenarios that underpins damages and valuation questions. I build tested pipelines in Python, R, and C++ on SLURM and AWS and turn results into figures and short reports on fixed deadlines, and I use Excel, Word, and PowerPoint for client-facing materials and presentations. With Professors Kohei Kawaguchi and Kei Kawai, I clean and link large bookstore point-of-sale records and estimate pricing and inventory under demand uncertainty, comparing competing models and checking robustness. I absorb new institutional detail and tools quickly, work both independently and in a team under deadline pressure, am willing to travel in Asia-Pacific as needed, and would welcome growing through FTI's CPA/CFA sponsorship and London training.

I have attached my resume and this cover letter. Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Ke-Cheng Hsu (Clio)